[AGENCY NAME / LOGO]

Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT) Program

Skills Training Session - Progress Note

Fillable form version for agency adaptation, for individual or group skills training delivered in person or by telehealth. Fields marked (F) correspond directly to scored items on the DBT program fidelity assessment (Group Skills Training section).

Client / Group Name: **Client ID / MRN (or Group ID):**

Date of Session: **Session # (this module cycle):**

Start Time: **End Time / Duration (min):**

Skills Leader: **Credential / License:**

Co-Leader (if group): **Co-Leader Credential:**

CPT / Service Code: **# Members Present (if group):**

Session Format:

Individual Group

Modality:

In person Telehealth - video Telehealth - audio only

If Individual format: DBT fidelity criteria treat individual skills training as a rare circumstance, to be reviewed with the consultation team.

If individual format, clinical rationale (e.g., medical/psychiatric symptom severity, no group available):

Reviewed with DBT consultation team N/A - group format used

If group format, two skills leaders present for this session:

Yes No N/A - individual format

1. Session Structure & Duration (F)

(Fidelity: Group Skills Training - Criteria 1, 3, 4)

Session structure completed today (check all that apply):

Mindfulness practice / exercise

Homework review

Break

New skill teaching

Skills practice exercise(s)

Wind-down / preview of next session

Session duration met the minimum required for this format:

Minimums: individual or in-home session >= 60 minutes; group of 3 or fewer members >= 90 minutes; group of more than 3 members >= 120 minutes.

Yes No

2. Mindfulness Practice & Homework Review (F)

(scoring item 5)

Mindfulness exercise conducted this session:

Yes No

Type / description of mindfulness exercise:

Client(s) reported observations of mindfulness practice:

Yes No N/A - not yet introduced

Homework from previous session reviewed:

Yes No N/A - first session

Homework completion:

Fully Partially Not completed

Barriers to completion (if any):

Comprehension check - questions asked to confirm client understanding:

Yes No

3. Skills Units & Skills Taught This Session (F)

(Fidelity: Group Skills Training - scoring item 2)

DBT Skills Training Manual edition used as source:

Linehan 2015 (2nd ed.) Linehan 2025 Other:

Check every specific skill covered or practiced this session.

Mindfulness (Core Mindfulness Skills)

Wise Mind Observe Describe

Participate Non-judgmentally One-mindfully

Effectively

Distress Tolerance

STOP Skill Pros and Cons TIP Skills

Distract - ACCEPTS Self-Soothe (Five Senses) IMPROVE the Moment

Radical Acceptance Turning the Mind Willingness vs. Willfulness

Half-Smiling / Willing Hands Mindfulness of Current Thoughts

Emotion Regulation

Understanding & Naming Emotions Check the Facts

Opposite Action Problem Solving

ABC PLEASE (Reducing Vulnerability) Building Mastery / Coping Ahead

Mindfulness of Current Emotion

Interpersonal Effectiveness

DEAR MAN GIVE FAST

Building / Ending Relationships Validation Skills

Other / agency-specific skill(s) taught:

Manual reference (chapter / handout / page):

4. Skills Practice / In-Session Exercise (F)

(scoring item 6)

Exercise, role-play, or practice conducted in session to elicit new skillful behavior:

Yes No

Description:

5. Clinical Observations

Engagement / participation level:

Mood / affect (group or individual):

Additional clinical observations:

6. Homework Assignment (F)

(Fidelity: Group Skills Training - scoring item 8)

Homework is required each session, with clear instructions and content relevant to this session's topic and the client's needs.

Homework Assignment:

Due / to be reviewed at next session:

7. Plan

Next scheduled session:

Plan / continued focus for next session:

Signature

Skills Leader Signature:

Credentials:

Date / Time Note Completed:

Co-Leader Signature (if applicable):

Date:

Appendix A: Fidelity Crosswalk

Reference page for clinical directors, trainers, and fidelity reviewers - remove before this note is finalized as a client-record document. Shows how each field above documents a specific item scored on the agency's DBT program fidelity assessment (Group Skills Training section).

Note Field	Corresponding Fidelity Scale Item
Header block - Session Format (Individual/Group)	Group Skills Training criterion 1: 'Stage One DBT clients participate in skills training, delivered in a group format or (more rarely) in an individual format separate from the individual session.'
Individual-format rationale / consultation team review field	Group Skills Training criterion 5: 'In rare circumstances ... clients may receive skills training individually; this is reviewed with the team.'
Co-leader presence field	Group Skills Training criterion 2 / scoring item 1: 'two skills leaders are present for at least 80% of full sessions.'
Section 1 - Session structure checklist	Scoring item 3: 'the structure of skills training is not followed (mindfulness, homework review, break, teaching).'
Section 1 - Session duration field	Group Skills Training criterion 3 / scoring item 4: minimum session length by format (60 / 90 / 120 minutes).
Section 2 - Mindfulness & homework report, comprehension check	Scoring item 5: each individual is required to report on observations of mindfulness and/or homework, and pertinent questions are asked to ascertain client understanding.
Section 3 - Manual edition field & skills checklist	Scoring item 2: 'the DBT Skills Training Manual (Linehan 2015 or 2025) is used as a source for skills training and/or content is [not] incorrectly taught.'
Section 4 - Skills practice / in-session exercise	Scoring item 6: 'exercises are [not] done in group to pull new behaviors from clients as they learn skills.'
Section 6 - Homework Assignment line	Scoring item 8: homework is required and instructions are clear, with assignments relevant to the topic/client needs.

Note: cancellation/early-dismissal frequency (scoring item 7) is tracked at the program level via the group schedule and attendance log, not on a per-session basis in this note.

Scoring context (from the fidelity assessment's Score Summary):

Group Skills Training and each other domain are rated 1-5. Consistent presence of the elements above supports higher domain scores; frequent gaps push scores toward 1-2 regardless of clinical quality elsewhere in the note.

Program-level bands: 62-70+ = good implementation | 52-61 = fair implementation | 51 and below = not evidence-based practice.